

Ἀρριανός ὁ Νικομηδεύς

## Anabasis and Epictetus in Arrian of Nicomedia

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**Period:** Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)  
**Dialect:** Ἀττικίζουσα [Atticizing](#)  
**Domain:** Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)  
**Format:** Πεζός [Prose](#)  
**Affiliation:** [Stoic](#)

Arrian was a Greek historian, philosopher, and Roman official of the 2nd century CE. Born around 86 CE in Nicomedia, he came from a provincial elite family and received a thorough education. He is most famous for being a devoted student of the Stoic philosopher Epictetus. He recorded his teacher's lectures in the Discourses of Epictetus and compiled a summary of core principles in the Enchiridion, or Handbook. These works are the primary source for Epictetus's philosophy and became foundational texts for Stoicism.

Alongside his philosophical work, Arrian had a successful career in the Roman imperial administration, serving as a consul and later as the governor and military commander of Cappadocia. As an author, he wrote on diverse subjects. His most important historical work is the Anabasis of Alexander, which is considered the most reliable ancient account of Alexander the Great's campaigns. He also wrote other surviving works, including a survey of the Black Sea coast, the Periplus, and a treatise on hunting, the Cyneticus. Many of his other historical works, such as his histories of the period after Alexander and of the Parthian Wars, are now lost.

Arrian's significance is twofold. He preserved Stoic ethical philosophy for later generations, and he provided a major historical narrative modeled on classical Greek historians like Xenophon. His life and writings exemplify the integration of Greek intellectual culture and Roman political service during the peak of the Roman Empire.

### Works (18)

- Ἀλεξάνδρου Ἀνάβασις · [Alexander's Anabasis](#) · 1108 passages
- Τέχνη τακτική · [Art of Tactics](#) · 202 passages
- Ἑκταξίς κατὰ Ἀλανῶν · [Battle-the Alans](#) · 28 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Ἀλανικῆς Ἱστορίας · [Fragment from Alanic History](#) · 1 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Βιθυνικῶν · [Fragments of Bithynica](#) · 75 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Παρθικῶν · [Fragments of Parthica](#) · 107 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Παρθικῶν · [Fragments of Parthica, According to John Lydus and Syncellus](#) · 1 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Ἱπικῆς Τακτικῆς · [Fragments on Cavalry Tactics](#) · 3 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα Φυσικῶν · [Fragments-Physical Matters](#) · 9 passages
- Ἱστορία τῶν Διαδόχων Ἀλεξάνδρου · [History of Alexander's Successors](#) · 106 passages
- Ἱστορία τῶν Διαδόχων Ἀλεξάνδρου · [History of Alexander's Successors](#) · 6 passages
- Κυνηγετικός · [Hunting](#) · 120 passages

- [Ἰνδική · Indica](#) · 344 passages
- [Ἐπιστολή πρὸς Λούκιον Γέλλιον · Letter to Lucius Gellius](#) · 1 passages
- [Περίπλους τοῦ Εὐξείνου Πόντου · Periplus of the Black Sea](#) · 99 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα · Succession Fragments after Alexander](#) · 204 passages
- [Μαρτυρίαι · Testimonies](#) · 11 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα Ἀβέβαια · Uncertain Fragments](#) · 28 passages

## Other Stoic Authors

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- [Ἀντίπατρος ὁ Ταρσεύς · Antipater of Tarsus](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀπολλόδωρος ὁ Σελευκεύς · Apollodorus of Seleucia](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀπολλοφάνης ὁ Στωϊκός · Apollophanes the Stoic](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρχέδημος ὁ Ταρσεύς · Archedemus of Tarsus](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀρίστων ὁ Χῖος · Ariston of Chios](#) · 1 work
- [Ἄρειος Δίδυμος · Arius Didymus of Alexandria](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀθηνόδωρος Κορδυλίων · Athenodorus of Tarsus Cordylian](#) · 1 work
- [Χαιρήμων ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεύς · Chaeremon of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- [Χρύσιππος ὁ Σολεύς · Chrysippus of Soli](#) · 6 works
- [Χρύσιππος ὁ Σολεύς · Chrysippus of Soli II](#) · 1 work
- [Κλεάνθης ὁ Ἀσσεύς · Cleanthes of Assos](#) · 2 works
- [Κορνοῦτος ὁ Στωϊκός · Cornutus the Stoic Philosopher](#) · 1 work